



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 45

UTAH

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Utah's family courts and child-welfare system.

30

UTAH FAMILIES ON RECORD · 52
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 7 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 5, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

9 OF 29

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

UTAH AT A GLANCE.

Across 30 Utah families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 52 29 of 30 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$157,200 median across 19 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 7 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 56.7% 53.3% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 30	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 29 of 30	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 9

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Utah families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF UTAH FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	23	\$29,000	\$51,130	\$1,176,000
Lost Wages	20	\$48,000	\$112,925	\$2,258,500
Other Court Fees	11	\$1,800	\$7,186	\$79,050
Therapy / Evaluations	14	\$3,000	\$6,744	\$94,410
Reunification Services	9	\$750	\$4,472	\$40,250
GAL Fees	16	\$1,800	\$5,538	\$88,600
Asset Loss	20	\$54,000	\$255,105	\$5,102,100
Median Family Burden (19 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$157,200	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		7	0.6 yrs
Mean months lost		22	1.8 yrs
Total across all families		467	38.9 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · UTAH

Most families documenting in Utah are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		17	57%
Not provided		5	17%
Case closed: within last 2 years		4	13%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		2	7%
Active case: progress being made		1	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		18	60%
Family Court Only		8	27%
Unknown		2	7%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		1	3%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)		1	3%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

3 – 5 years		11	37%
1 – 3 years		6	20%
5 – 10 years		4	13%
6 months – 1 year		4	13%
Less than 6 months		1	3%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only		10	33%
50/50 Joint		8	27%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		6	20%
Full Custody		3	10%
Children in Foster Care		1	3%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Salt Lake		7	23%
Davis		4	13%
Weber		2	7%
Iron		2	7%
Cache		1	3%
Utah		1	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		13	43%
High Conflict Divorce		4	13%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		4	13%
Other		3	10%
Other: (Short answer)		3	10%

04 PARENT VOICES — UTAH

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Utah comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



CPS took my kids for 10 months because they spoke up about abuse the other parent was doing. They said I coached my kids even though I had hospital records and PO from another judge still fighting for sole custody especially because my ex wanted our children to stay in foster [...]

— HALEY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Access to children only to abuser(my ex husband) denied regular updates and photos as entitled to after termination of rights

— UTAH PARENT · CHERYL

MORE VOICES FROM UTAH

Allowed my abuser to continue to abuse me legally through the system and made it so no contact with my abuser put my child right in the path with no way out. We have a safe word and escape plan. The judge said to me, and I quote word for word, “he tried to kill you, not the kid [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Complete psychological terrorism. My adult daughters testified in court against my ex (who also abused them), the judge gas lit them, discredited their testimonies. After his corrupt ruling, they both said to me "I'm never having kids". Destroyed their future and hopes for [...]

— LIZ

Absolutely destroyed our family dynamic and the deep bond our children had shared with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Wedge between me and my kids, false accusations. Long term mediation resulting in supervised visitations. Paid.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has kept me and my children in a prolonged, high-conflict process where repeated litigation, delays, and enforcement gaps have allowed instability to continue instead of creating lasting protection and consistency in which it's supposed to be intended [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has robbed me of time with my daughter. That can never be replaced or given back, Memory's that I won't have .

— RACHEL

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Incentivizes DIVORCE and the breakup of families, RAPES mostly good men/fathers of being fathers to their children and of money/income to take care of their kids and themselves for the rest of their lives. Places their kids in HIGH RISK categories of crime, depression, suicide [...]

— CHRIS

Utah Courts are known as the judicial industrial complex. It's a farce and creates acrimony and billable hours. Judges hands are not clean.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex has admitted to domestic violence in his court documents, he has been high on drugs around kids and court looking to give him 50/50 through a GAL, while making me pay for psych evals. GAL came out in favor for dad without even talking to me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Let the one who hates the most, has the most money, and uses our children, be rewarded with the privilege of raising our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has tore our family apart. Some of the saddest most painful moments I have ever been through.

— JIM

This system abused my babies and I for financial gain. Lied and abused power because I tried to stand up, we did nothing wrong and was still punched.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Court ordered that my two boys go live with their unemployed father who has a Protective Order (and has been arrested) after he coached them to tell a therapist I was abusive. Even the therapist said the children's stories didn't make sense, but she had to report regardless.

— ELIZABETH

They have destroyed me and my daughters life. I don't know what to do or how I can fix any of this. I am up against monsters that don't play by the rules.

— IVY

At a time when our family needed one another the most, they separated us. The results, the outcome, the irresponsibility, unfathomable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Haven't held my boys since may 8 th 2021. Haven't had one moment of connection. Now we are strangers. Now they are weapons to hurt me and nothing more. They are now motherless and I am alone

— KACIE

It's too painful to type in one box. I've been put through three custody evaluations so far. Looking at a fourth. Has gone on for 15 years in two states with two different exes teaming up to lie for each other to get out of child support

— ANGELA

It has caused serious emotional and psychological damage to both siblings as well as myself and our family. We have done absolutely nothing that should have had my child removed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex husband has taken everything he threatened to with the exception of the lives of the children and I. I am terrified to fight back because I recognize all prior threats made were followed through on. I have to choose between staying silent or risking him ending our lives. [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has repeatedly prioritized procedural disputes and allegations over documented concerns about my child's safety, forcing me into ongoing legal battles while I continue to follow professional guidance and report disclosures appropriately. As a result, my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Reprimanded me for kissing my newborn after 4 hours of un-medicated labor, threatened with jail time due to false allegations alienation, callously told me to "just pump" rather than being able to breastfeed my infant, lost full custody due to false allegations of alienation [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

23 Utah parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 23 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — UTAH

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Utah families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

CPS took my kids for 10 months because they spoke up about abuse the other parent was doing. They said I coached my kids even though I had hospital records and PO from another judge still fighting for sole custody especially because my ex wanted our children to stay in foster care.

— **HALEY**

Allowed my abuser to continue to abuse me legally through the system and made it so no contact with my abuser put my child right in the path with no way out. We have a safe word and escape plan. The judge said to me, and I quote word for word, "he tried to kill you, not the kid, so the kid is safe. You will never be safe around his father." What the hell!!! Also, false, I have 2 older kids and my ex called there dad so there are less witnesses. He made our son stay. He had full intent to kill my son, make me watch, kill me, then himself. Guns were mounted in every room and he was vocal about his plan. He is a malignant narcissist, they can't help but lay out their agenda.

— **ANONYMOUS PARENT**

Complete psychological terrorism. My adult daughters testified in court against my ex (who also abused them), the judge gas lit them, discredited their testimonies. After his corrupt ruling, they both said to me "I'm never having kids". Destroyed their future and hopes for healthy families, etc. Allowed my two little ones to be abused repeatedly and their father given full protection and immunity from investigation and accountability.

— **LIZ**

Access to children only to abuser(my ex husband) denied regular updates and photos as entitled to after termination of rights

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Absolutely destroyed our family dynamic and the deep bond our children had shared with me.

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05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The family court system has kept me and my children in a prolonged, high-conflict process where repeated litigation, delays, and enforcement gaps have allowed instability to continue instead of creating lasting protection and consistency in which it's supposed to be intended for. So far it has given an abuser temporary custody, now he's trying to take it again for false reasons, with the gal on his side. It has forced me to parent under constant scrutiny and emotional strain while my children remain exposed to financial strain uncertainty, conflict their father won't stop, and avoidable disruption to their wellbeing due to him being allowed to bring me to court every year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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Incentivizes DIVORCE and the breakup of families, RAPES mostly good men/fathers of being fathers to their children and of money/income to take care of their kids and themselves for the rest of their lives. Places their kids in HIGH RISK categories of crime, depression, suicide, and future happiness being good citizens of the country - a plague on society.

— CHRIS

Utah Courts are known as the judicial industrial complex. It's a farce and creates acrimony and billable hours. Judges hands are not clean.

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My ex has admitted to domestic violence in his court documents, he has been high on drugs around kids and court looking to give him 50/50 through a GAL, while making me pay for psych evals. GAL came out in favor for dad without even talking to me.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has repeatedly prioritized procedural disputes and allegations over documented concerns about my child's safety, forcing me into ongoing legal battles while I continue to follow professional guidance and report disclosures appropriately. As a result, my family has experienced emotional, financial, and psychological strain while I work to protect my child and maintain stability in the face of repeated motions, accusations, and delayed responses to evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Reprimanded me for kissing my newborn after 4 hours of un-medicated labor, threatened with jail time due to false allegations alienation, callously told me to "just pump" rather than being able to breastfeed my infant, lost full custody due to false allegations of alienation, lost medical authority due false allegations of non-compliance in with medical records.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

23 full approved Utah comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Utah report comes from Utah respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Utah — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 30 Utah families reporting here are not the universe of Utah families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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